

The best way to test your speeds is to make your site live and ask a friend with a broadband connection to help you test it. Perhaps the simplest way to get a site up is to use EasyPHP, as we've mentioned earlier in this book. You can just use EasyPHP as your Web server, even if your site is

HTML-based and not PHP/MySQL-based, because all you need to do is place all the files in the “.\EasyPHP\www\” directory and then go to <http://localhost/> to check it.



You can use EasyPHP itself to host your site

Now, for a friend to be able to help you test it, you need to have an IP address. A lot of ISPs will not give you a public IP address (an IP that's accessible from the Internet), so if your ISP is one of those, you're out of luck. If you do have a public IP address, however, you can go ahead and host your site.

10.1.2 Getting set to host

In order to find your IP address, visit www.whatsmyip.org or www.shomyip.com and note down your IP. If you go to whatsmyip.org, click on your IP address on the top (it's a link) to see more information about your IP and your ISP.

Now, you have to figure out whether your IP changes or not, so it's best to call up your ISP's help desk and find this out. If it



Check your IP at whatismyip.org